

Hypertension - Causes and Management

Hypertension, or high blood pressure, is a chronic medical condition in which the force of blood against artery walls is elevated. It is often called the "silent killer" because it may not cause symptoms until significant damage has occurred. Risk factors include obesity, high salt intake, sedentary lifestyle, excessive alcohol consumption, and genetic predisposition. Uncontrolled hypertension increases the risk of heart attack, stroke, kidney disease, and vision loss. Management includes lifestyle modifications-such as regular exercise, healthy diet, and weight loss-and medications like ACE inhibitors, beta-blockers, and diuretics. Regular monitoring is essential for effective control.